

NLP Answer Sheet

Q1. What is POS Tagging? Why is it important?

POS (Part-of-Speech) tagging is a core task in Natural Language Processing (NLP) that involves assigning grammatical categories to each word in a sentence. These categories include noun, verb, adjective, pronoun, adverb, etc. POS tagging helps machines understand sentence structure and meaning.

Key Concepts in POS Tagging:

- **Parts of Speech:** Categories like nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, pronouns, etc. that define the role of a word in a sentence.
- **Tagging:** The process of assigning a specific part-of-speech label to each word in a sentence.
- **Corpus:** A large collection of text data used to train POS taggers.

Types of POS Tagging:

1. **Rule-Based POS Tagging:** Uses handcrafted linguistic rules to assign tags.
2. **Stochastic POS Tagging:** Uses probabilistic models such as Hidden Markov Models (HMM) to predict tags.
3. **Transformation-Based POS Tagging:** Combines rule-based and statistical approaches.
4. **Neural POS Tagging:** Uses deep learning and neural networks for tagging.

Why is POS Tagging Important?

- **Syntactic Analysis:** POS tags help in understanding the grammatical structure of a sentence, which is essential for parsing.

Example:

Sentence: "The cat sat on the mat."

POS Tags: The/DT cat/NN sat/VBD on/IN the/DT mat/NN

Analysis: The tags show that "cat" is a noun, "sat" is a verb, and "on" is a preposition.

- **Semantic Understanding:** Knowing the role of a word in a sentence helps in understanding meaning.

Ambiguity Example:

Sentence: "I saw the man with the telescope."

POS Tags: I/PRP saw/VBD the/DT man/NN with/IN the/DT telescope/NN

Analysis: POS tags help clarify whether "with the telescope" modifies "saw" or "the man".

- **Disambiguation:** Many words in natural language are ambiguous and can belong to multiple parts of speech depending on context.